

that proportional representation of each service was maintained. This was counter to General Abrams's original plan, which would have seen the bulk of initial redeployment focus on the Marine Corps; arguments about the makeup of each increment would continue into 1972.

“Hey man, tell them **back in the world we’re coming **home**, and **we’re never coming back**.”**

A US ARMY MEDIC SPEAKS TO DOCUMENTARY FILMMAKER JOHN PILGER FOR THE QUIET MUTINY, 1970



Desperate and fatigued

A US infantryman lies exhausted on the ground as he drinks from a canteen in the Fishhook region. The US suffered heavy losses during grueling combat there in 1970, relying on a steady influx of troops to replace the fallen.

Racial tensions

For those left behind in Vietnam, morale was in freefall. The US military during the late 1960s reflected the same issues prevalent at home. Before 1969, troops in Vietnam were not immune to the racial tensions in American society, but combat had a way of bonding warriors. After 1969, however, the self-segregation of soldiers off duty or in rear areas away from active combat became ever more apparent. This practice likely mirrored attitudes brought over from the United States.

Threats to discipline